

PLACEMENT READINESS · COMMUNICATION TRACK

STAR Method & Technical HR

Session 1 — Building structured, confident answers for BTech placement interviews

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What You'll Walk Away With

Session Objectives

01

Understand Behavioural Interviews

Why recruiters ask about your past to predict how you'll perform on the job.

03

Build Confidence

Move from rehearsed facts to answers you can deliver naturally, under pressure.

02

Learn the STAR Framework

A repeatable structure for turning any experience into a clear, complete answer.

04

Practice Real Interview Answers

Apply the framework live, with peer feedback, before you need it for real.

What Recruiters Look For

Beyond the technical answer, these are the signals they're scoring

C

Communication

Can you explain clearly and concisely?

P

Problem Solving

How do you approach a challenge?

T

Teamwork

Do you collaborate or work in isolation?

L

Leadership

Can you take ownership when needed?

C

Confidence

Do you believe in your own answer?

What Behavioural Questions Sound Like

Every one of these is really asking: “can you tell a clear story about something you did?”



Describe a challenge you faced and how you handled it.



Tell me about a project you're proud of.



Describe a time you led a team or an initiative.



Tell me about a time you worked in a team to solve a problem.

THE FRAMEWORK

The STAR Framework

One structure for every behavioural answer you'll ever give



Situation

Set the context



Task

Your responsibility



Action

What you did



Result

The outcome

S

Situation

Part 1 of 4 — STAR Framework

How to use it

- Explain the background briefly
- Where? When? What happened?
- Keep it to 2-3 sentences — set the scene, don't tell the whole story yet

EXAMPLE

"In my final year, our team was assigned a Library Management System project with a 6-week deadline."

T

Task

Part 2 of 4 — STAR Framework

How to use it

- What was YOUR specific responsibility?
- Focus on your role, not the whole team's
- This is where interviewers check you're not just describing a group effort

EXAMPLE

"I was responsible for designing the database schema and writing the core SQL queries."



Action

Part 3 of 4 — STAR Framework

How to use it

- Explain exactly what YOU did, step by step
- Use strong action verbs to keep it specific
- This should be the longest, most detailed part of your answer

EXAMPLE

"I designed the schema, wrote and tested the SQL queries, and fixed two performance issues before submission."

Action verbs to use:

Designed

Led

Created

Solved

Implemented

Built

Optimised

Debugged

R

Result

Part 4 of 4 — STAR Framework

How to use it

- End with a clear achievement or outcome
- Use numbers wherever possible — they're memorable and credible
- A vague result ("it went well") undoes an otherwise strong answer

EXAMPLE

"The project was submitted on time and received an A grade, with the professor highlighting the query performance."

Worked Example — Leadership

COLLEGE HACKATHON



Situation

Our college hackathon team needed a leader with two days' notice before the event.



Task

As team leader, I was responsible for dividing the work and keeping us on schedule.



Action

I divided tasks by strength, set 4-hour check-ins, and tracked progress on a shared board.



Result

We finished the build on time and were shortlisted among the top 10 teams.

Worked Example — Technical Project

LIBRARY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM



Situation

Our final-year team built a Library Management System with a 6-week deadline.



Task

I owned the database design — schema structure and query performance.



Action

I designed the schema, wrote the SQL queries, and tested and fixed two slow queries.



Result

The project received an A grade, with query performance specifically praised.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Small habits that quietly undo an otherwise strong STAR answer

✗ Using “We” instead of “I”

Interviewers are assessing YOUR contribution — be specific about your role.

✗ Forgetting the Result

An answer without an outcome feels incomplete — always close the loop.

✗ Too much technical jargon

Explain it so a non-technical interviewer could still follow along.

✗ Speaking too long

Aim for 60-90 seconds — concise answers read as more confident.

Class Activity

1

Write one STAR answer

Pick a real experience and draft it using the full framework.

2

Practice with a partner

Deliver it aloud — partners check all 4 parts are present.

3

Volunteer presentations

A few students share with the whole class for group feedback.

Homework

Prepare a full STAR answer for each of the following

P

Project

A technical project you built, designed, or contributed to.

L

Leadership

A time you took charge of a task, team, or initiative.

C

Challenge

A difficult situation you worked through and resolved.

Due at the start of the next session.

STAR

Thank You

Questions?

Practice makes placement-ready.